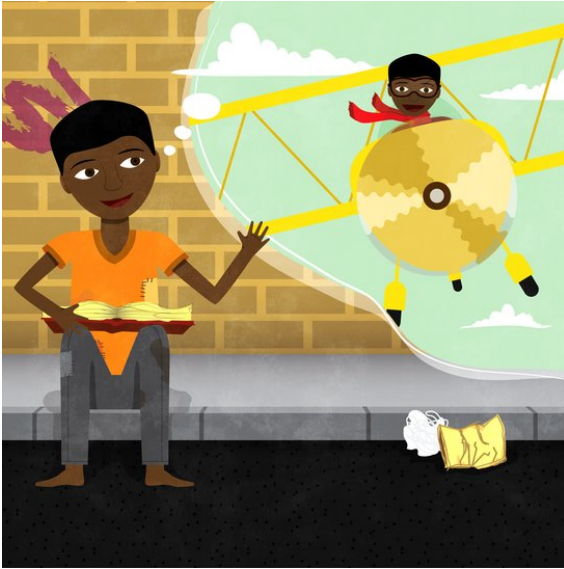




Magozwe

-  Lesley Koyi
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-  Eunice Mukonde-Mulenga
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-  IciBemba bem



Mwi tauni lya Nairobi, ukutali ne ndupwa ishabasakamene, mwaleikala abalumendo abashakwete amayanda. Baaleikalafye cikulu bwaca. Uluceelo lumu, abalumendo baaleelonga impasa shabo panuma yakulaala mumpepo mumbali yanshila. Ukubomfya ifisooso, baalikoseshe umulilo pakupwisha impepo. Pali ili bumba paali Magozwe. Ewaali umwaice saana.



Ilyo abafyashi bakwa Magozwe baafwile, aalifye ne myaka isaano. Aile mukwikala na banalume. Banalume tabapooseleko amaano kuli Magozwe. Taabaaleemupeela ifyakulya ifyakumanina. Baaleemupeela incito shakubomba ishingini.



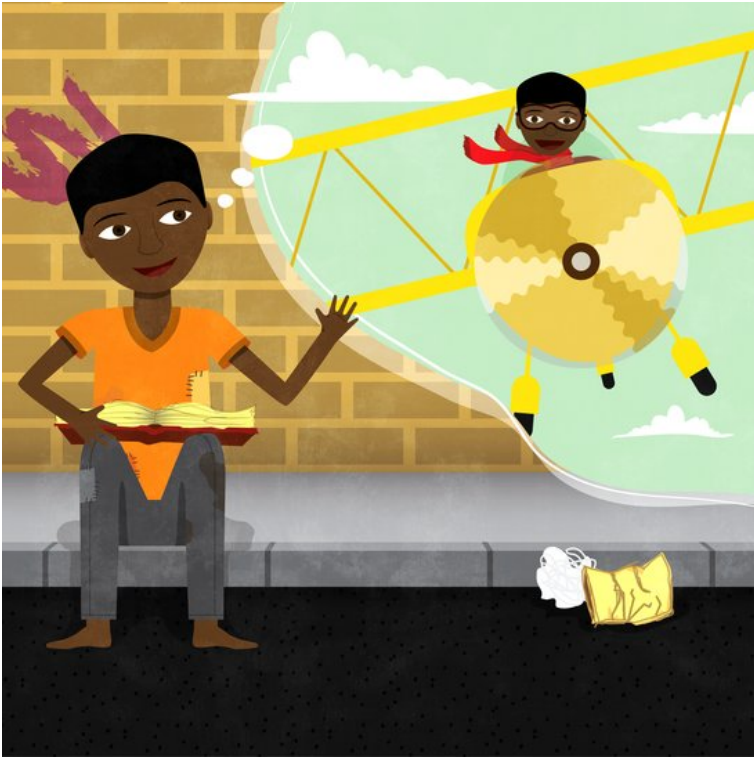
Nga Magozwe ati epushe nangu ukuilishanya, banalume baaleemuma. Ilyo Magozwe aipwishe palwa kuya ku sukulu, banalume baalimumine kabili baatiile, “Iwe tawakwata amaano. Tapali ico wingasambilila.” Panuma ya myaka itatatu iyakumusunga muli uyu musango, Magozwe aalibuutwike ukufuma pa njanda yaba nalume. Aatampile ukwikala mu musebo.



Ukwikala mu musebo kwali ukwayafya kabili abalumendo abengi baaleecuula cila bushiku pa kusanga icakulya. Inshiku shimo baaleebooma, shimbi baaleebeeekata kuli bakapokola. Nga baalwala takwaleeba abakubaafwa. Ulupiya baalesanga mu kulombalomba, mu kushitisha amapulasitiki na fimbi elwaleebaafwilishako. Ubumi bwalyafisheko pantu amabumba yambi ayabalumendo yaaleefwaya ukupoka incende shapusanapusana mu tauni.



Ubushiku bumo ilyo Magozwe aaleefwayafwaya mu fisooso, aasangile ibuuku ilyakale ilyalepauka. Aafumisheko ifiko aalibika na mwisaaka. Cila bushiku, aleefumya ibuuku no kwamba ukulolesha pa fikope. Taishibe ukubelenga.



Ifikope fyaleelanga umulumendo uwaishileba kensha wandeke ilyo aakulile. Magozwe aaleeloota palwa kuba kensha wandeke na mu kasuba. Inshita shimo aleemona ukuti emulumendo wine uwa mwibuku.



Kwalitaleele kabili Magozwe aiminine pa musebo aleelombalomba. Umwaume umo aishile mupeepi napo aali. “Uli shaani? Nine Thomas. Momba mupeepi napano, pa ncende wingapoka icakulya,” efyo aasosele. Asontele ku ganda iyamutuntula no mutenge wa makumbi-makumbi. “Ndesubila walaayapoka ifyakulya?” efyo aipwishe. Magozwe aaloleeshe Thomas elyo kabili aloleesha ku ganda. “Limbi ndeeya,” efyo ayaswike, afumanapo.



Imyeshi yakonkelepo, abalumendo baalibeeleshe ukumona Thomas. Alitemenwe ukulanda na bantu maka-maka abaaleikala mu musebo. Thomas aaleumfwa ilyashi pa buumi bwa aba bantu. Aaleepoosa amaano ku fintu kabili uwacikuuku no mucinshi. Abalumendo bamo, bayambile ukuya ku ganda ya mutuntula na Makumbi-makumbi mukupoka ifyakulya akasuba.



Magozwe aikele mumbali yanshila aleetamba ifikope mwibuuku lyakwe ilyo Thomas aishileikala mupeepi nankwe. “Lileelanda pali cinshi ilyashi?” efyo Thomas aipwishe. “Lileelanda pa mulumendo uwaishileba kensha wandeke,” efyaaswike Magozwe. “Naani ishina umulumendo?” efyaipwishe Thomas. “Katwishi, nshaishiba ukubelenga,” efyayaswike Magozwe mwishiwi lya panshi.



Ilyo baakumeene, Magozwe aatendeke ukweba Thomas ilyashi pa buumi bwakwe. Aamwebele ifyo aabuutwike ukufuma kuli banalume. Thomas taalaandile ifingi kabili taebele Magozwe ifyakucita lelo aaleumfwikishafye. Limo-limo baaleelanshanya ilyo baleelya mu njanda yamutenge wa Makumbi-makumi.



Ilyo Magozwe aali ne myaka ikumi, Thomas alimupeelee ibuuku. Ibuuku lyali pa mulumendo wa mumushi uwaleeteya umupila uwalumbwike saana. Thomas alibelengeele Magozwe ili lyashi imiku iingi mpakafye bushiku bumo atiile, “Ndetontonkanya ukuti ulingile ukutampa isukulu pakuti usambilile ukubelenga. Uleetipo shani?” Thomas atiile alishibe incende uko abaana bengalaikala no kuya ku sukulu.



Magozwe aatontonkenye pali ii ncende iipya na palwa kuya ku sukulu. Nga limbi ifyo banalume bamwebele ukuti taakwata amaano teeti asambilile icili conse fyaciine? Nga cakuti kulya kuncende bamuuma? Alitiinine. “Limbi cawamapo ukutwalilila ukwikala mu musebo,” efyo aatontonkenye.



Aebele Thomas ati aali no mwenso. Thomas nao alimukoseleshe ukuti akeekalafye bwino kuncende ilya.



Efyo Magozwe aile mukwikala mu muputule mu
ņanda yamutenge wa katapa-katapa. Aaleikalamo
na balumendo bambi babili. Abaana bonse pamo
abaleeikala muli ilya ņanda baali ikumi. Elyo naba
maama Cissy na balume baabo ne mbwa shitatu,
puushi elyo ne mbushi iikote.



Magozwe alyambile isukulu kabili lyalikosele. Fiingi ashaishibe ifyo aalingile ukwishiba pakuti alingane na banankwe. Limo-limo aaleefwaya no kuleka isukulu. Leelo aaleetontonkanyo pali kensha wandekwe na kateya wa mupila abamumabuuku yakwe. Taalekele nga filya fine nabo bashalekele.



Magozwe aikeele panse pa lubansa lwa njanda ya mutenge wa katapa-katapa, aleebelenga ibuuku lyaku sukulu. Thomas nao aishile ikala mupeepi nankwe. “Lilelanda pali cinshi ilyashi?” efyaipwishe Thomas. “Lilelanda pa mulumendo awaishileba kafundisha,” efyayaswike Magozwe. “Naani ishina umulumendo?” efyaipwishe Thomas. “Ishina lyakwe ni Magozwe,” efyalandile Magozwe ninshi aleemwentula.



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